Sydney L. White

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Education

Columbia University
Ph.D. Student in Political Science (As of Fall 2024)
Subfields: Comparative Politics and Political Methodology

Swarthmore College
B.A. 2022, Graduated High Honors with Political Science Major, French Minor

Yale University
Took PhD methods and game theory coursework in the Political Science Department:
Foundations of Statistical Inference (Fall 2022),
Theory & Practice of Quantitative Methods (Spring 2023),
Introduction to Game Theory (Fall 2023)

Employment

Yale University
Predoctoral Fellow for Prof. Kenneth Scheve — June 2022- June 2024

Citigroup
Investment Banking Analyst (Financial Institutions Group) — Summer 2021

Bank of America
Sales and Trading Analyst (Bonds & Equities, Rotation) — Summer 2020

Working Papers

"Market Power and Distorted Democracy in the Progressive Era", with Kenneth Scheve and Theo Serlin, 2026

Works in Progress

"Narratives and Electoral Responses to Financial Crises: Evidence from the 1907 Bankers' Panic"

Grants and Awards

Giancarlo Doria Prize — 2026
Awarded by the Columbia Department of Political Science for the best paper in any subfield submitted by a pre-M.Phil. Ph.D. candidate.

International Political Economy Idea Lab — 2026
Columbia Center for Political Economy Research Grant

Presentations

Comparative Politics Seminar, Columbia University, 2026

CBS-Princeton Money in Politics Conference, 2026

International Political Economy Society, 2026

Teaching

Columbia University

Senior Honors Seminar (undergraduate) — Fall 2026–Spring 2027
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Timothy Frye

Statistical Theory and Causal Inference (graduate) Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant to Prof. John Marshall

The Rise of the Modern World Economy (undergraduate) Fall 2025
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Jeffry Frieden

Yale University

PhD Math Camp (graduate) August 2023
Teaching Assistant, Department of Political Science

Data

Furnace-Level Dataset of United States Iron and Steel Production, 1880–1916
Authors: Kenneth Scheve, Theo Serlin, Sydney White

A Historical Dataset on Governors of the United States and Its Territories
Authors: Sydney White, Kenneth Scheve, Theo Serlin, and Neel Gupta

Service & Administration

Lead Administrator Roles

- Lead Teaching Fellow, Columbia Political Science 2026-2027
- Lead Admin, International Political Economy Society (IPES) 2022 – Present
- Lead Admin, Political Economy of International Finance (PEIF) 2026
- Lead Admin, Columbia Seminar on International Economics and Geopolitics 2025 – Present

Other Service and Organizational Roles

- Swarthmore Admissions Office Alumni Interviewer Fall 2023
- Yale Law School Lowenstein (Pro-Bono) Project Researcher Fall 2022
- Pride Month Planning Committee, Swarthmore 2021 – 2022
- Student Chair, Swarthmore Political Science Search Committee Fall 2021
  Search: Tenure-track position in Constitutional Law
- French Department Tutor, Swarthmore 2021 – 2022

Skills

Technical: R, Python, Julia, ArcGIS, Latex
Languages: English (native), French (proficient)
Other research methods: Experience with archival methods

References

Jeffry Frieden, Professor of International and Public Affairs and Political Science, Columbia University, `j.frieden@columbia.edu`

Kenneth Scheve, I.A. O'Shaughnessy Dean,
University of Notre Dame `kscheve@nd.edu`